

Board 1

South Deals

None Vul

♠ K Q J 10

♥ 10 9

♦ 7 4 3

♣ K 10 7 2

♠ 8 6 5 3

♥ K 5 4

♦ K J 10 8 5

♣ Q



♠ A 9 2

♥ J 7 3

♦ A 9 2

♣ J 9 6 5

♠ 7 4

♥ A Q 8 6 2

♦ Q 6

♣ A 8 4 3

West

North

East

South

Pass

3♥

Pass

4♥

All Pass

4♥ by South

Lead: ♠K

Some pretty aggressive bidding gets you to a challenging game. South is to play 4♥. West leads the ♠K, overtaken by East's ♠A. East returns a ♠ to West's ♠10, and he then plays the ♠Q.

Losers: ♠=2 ♥=0 ♦=1 ♣=3 Total = 6

With 2 tricks already gone you still have 4 losers. You could consider ruffing the 3 ♣ losers in dummy but that would just create a trump loser even when trumps are splitting 3-2. So it looks like you will have to establish the ♦ suit for discards. You could pull trumps and then play your ♦Q, hoping the defenders will grab their ♦A immediately. But unless they are real novices they will hold it up one round and you'll no longer be able to reach dummy.

The solution is to establish the ♦s before you use up dummy's ♥K.

Ruff the third ♠, then play ♦Q, (which they will duck), and another ♦, (which they will probably take). Win whatever they return, pull trumps ending in dummy, and enjoy your 3 ♦ winners.

If East does not take the second ♦ you continue the suit, and whether you ruff or discard a loser you still make the contract.

Board 2

South Deals

None Vul

♠ K 10 8 6
♥ 9 6 3
♦ Q 7 2
♣ J 9 2

♠ Q J 9

♥ K Q 10 5 4

♦ 9 4

♣ 8 6 3

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ 4 3 2

♥ A 8 2

♦ K J 5

♣ Q 10 7 4

♠ A 7 5

♥ J 7

♦ A 10 8 6 3

♣ A K 5

West	North	East	South
			1NT
Pass	2♦	Pass	2♥
Pass	2NT	Pass	3NT
All Pass			

3NT by South

Lead: ♠6

trick, then start on ♥s. East will hold up the ♥A for 1 or 2 rounds. When he does win it he will return a ♠ and whether you play the ♠A or a low ♠ West will be able to prevent you from reaching dummy.

But if you win the first trick with the ♠A, then dummy's ♠ Q J will provide a guaranteed entry to the good ♥s.

North's 3♦ bid was a transfer to ♥s, and his 2NT bid showed exactly 5 ♥s with an invitational strength hand. South is to play 3NT. West leads the ♠6, you play dummy's ♠9 and East contributes the ♠2.

Winners: ♠=2 ♥=0 ♦=1 ♣=2 Total = 5

The math is easy - you need 4 ♥ tricks. And you should be able to manage that by driving out the ♥A. But the defenders will probably hold up one or two rounds when you play on ♥s, so you must have an outside entry to dummy.

The ♠ Q J will provide that entry **IF** you make sure to win the first trick with your ♠A as an unblocking move. If you don't do so then West will be able to keep you out of the dummy and away from those good ♥s.

Suppose you allow dummy's ♠9 to hold the first trick, then start on ♥s. East will hold up the ♥A for 1 or 2 rounds. When he does win it he will return a ♠ and whether you play the ♠A or a low ♠ West will be able to prevent you from reaching dummy.

Board 3

West Deals

None Vul

♠ Q 9 7 2

♥ K 6 4

♦ 10 8 2

♣ Q 6 3

♠ K J 4

♥ Q J 10 5 3

♦ 7 5 4

♣ 8 2

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ 8 6 3

♥ A 8 2

♦ Q J 9

♣ J 10 7 4

♠ A 10 5

♥ 9 7

♦ A K 6 3

♣ A K 9 5

West

Pass

Pass

Pass

All Pass

3NT by South

Lead: ♠ 2

Instead you should win the first trick with your ♠ A. Now when you attack ♥s a defensive holdup won't hurt you because you have **TWO** ♠ entries, the ♠ J by a finesse and the ♠ K.

West is almost certain to hold the ♠ Q because his ♠ 2 opening lead promises an honor and the ♠ Q is the only one you don't have.

So the ♠ finesse is an odds-on play to get a second dummy entry.

South is to play 3NT. West leads the ♠ 2, you play dummy's ♠ 4 and East plays the ♠ 8.

Winners: ♠=3 ♥=0 ♦=2 ♣=2 Total = 7

Needing just two more winners it looks straightforward to establish dummy's ♥ suit.

Suppose you win the ♠ 10 and play the ♥ 9. If the defenders win this trick you are home free. You win their ♠ return with your ♠ A, then continue ♥s to drive out their last stopper while you still have the ♠ K as a dummy entry.

This won't work against good defenders, who will hold up on the first ♥ trick and win the second. Then when they continue ♠s you won't have another ♥ to return to dummy, so while you can use the ♠ K as an entry to establish the ♥s you will never get back to use the good ones.

Board 4

East Deals

None Vul

♠ 10 9 6
♥ Q 10 7 2
♦ 9 4 3
♣ K Q 8

♠ Q J 8 2

♥ A 6 3

♦ Q 10 8

♣ 9 4 3

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ A K 7 5 4 3

♥ J 9 5

♦ -

♣ J 10 7 2

♠ -

♥ K 8 4

♦ A K J 7 6 5 2

♣ A 6 5

West	North	East	South
		2 ♠	Dbl
Pass	2NT	Pass	3 ♦
Pass	4 ♦	Pass	5 ♦
All Pass			
5 ♦ by South			
Lead: ♠ 10			

3NT would have been a lot easier, but you didn't get there. South is to play 5 ♦. West leads the ♠ 10.

Losers: ♠=0 ♥=1 ♦=0 ♣=2 Total = 3

The good news is that you only have one loser to get rid of. The bad news is that there doesn't seem to be a good place to put it.

Unlikely as it seems, your best candidate for establishment is dummy's ♠ 8. West is marked with 3 ♠s, and having led the ♠ 10 there is a good chance that he also has the ♠ 9. If so you can ruff it out.

Cover the ♠ 10 with dummy's ♠ J, and when East plays one of his honors ruff in your hand. Play a trump to the ♦ 10, East showing out. Lead the ♠ Q. East will be forced to play his other high honor, (if he doesn't you would discard a loser), and you ruff again.

Back to dummy with the ♦ Q and ruff the ♠ 2 with a high trump just to be safe. West drops the ♠ 9 on this trick.

Pull West's last trump and enter dummy with the ♥ A and **FINALLY** discard a loser on the now established ♠ 8.

When your only hope of making a contract is for the defender's cards to be a certain way, just assume that they lie perfectly for you and barge ahead.

Here you needed ♠ 10 9 x to be with West if you were to make the contract so you played for just that holding.

Board 5

North Deals

None Vul

♠ 5 3
 ♥ J 7 6 4
 ♦ K J 7 3 2
 ♣ 10 5

♠ K 6 4

♥ A 9 3

♦ 8 6

♣ 9 8 6 4 3

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ 8 2

♥ Q 8 2

♦ Q 10 9 4

♣ Q J 7 2

♠ A Q J 10 9 7

♥ K 10 5

♦ A 5

♣ A K

West	North	East	South
	Pass	Pass	2 ♣
Pass	2NT	Pass	3 ♠
Pass	4 ♠	Pass	4NT
Pass	5 ♦	Pass	6 ♠
All Pass			
6 ♠ by South			
Lead: ♠ 5			

South is to play 6 ♠. West leads the ♠ 5.

Losers: ♠=0 ♥=1 ♦=1 ♣=0 Total = 2

First pull trumps with the ♠ A and ♠ Q, both defenders following. Next you must establish dummy's ♣ suit to get rid of one of your losers. If the suit splits 3-3 that will be easy since you have two dummy entries, one to get there to ruff the third ♣ and the other to get there to enjoy playing the winners. But ♣s will probably split 4-2 so the two entries won't be enough. Here's how to make the defenders help you establish the suit.

After pulling trumps, play the ♣ A K, then ♦ A. Next exit with a small ♦.

The defender who won the ♦ trick has a problem. If he plays another ♦ you will get a ruff-sluff, and if he plays a ♥ you will play for the ♥ Q and ♥ J to be in different hands. So he will probably play a ♣.

You ruff in your hand, play a trump to dummy's ♠ K and ruff the ♣ 8, establishing the ♣ 9 while you still have the ♥ entry.

Notice that this Plan would also succeed if the ♣s had split 3-3.

This was a combination of Suit Establishment and End-play. The lesson on Eliminations contains a lot more of this type of hand.